

Section 1: Short Answer Questions

1-If we need to benefit from Donnelly, first of all, there is the evaluation of classical realism and Hobbes. There is an interaction with anarchy in the state of nature, and issues such as competition and victory are also included. Situations in classical realism are based on conflict and power relations in human nature. In this case, power relations are state-based, there is no international context. On the other hand, there is an approach that includes the international system in structural realism. In this system, the distribution of power relations is examined and evokes concepts such as bipolarity, unipolarity, and multipolarity. On the other hand, Waltz defines the political system as consisting of unified units, principles, distribution of capabilities, and functional differences. Evaluating the concept of hierarchy and anarchy, Waltz argues that, unlike in classical realism, there is a state of submission in the hierarchy and even evokes a differentiation with legislative, executive, and judicial issues. In addition, in the case of anarchy, there is little differentiation. Because units must protect themselves in the case of trust. On the other hand, in classical realism regarding the balance of power, the balance of power evokes the desire to be a hegemon because there is a power search. In structural realism, the situation is shaped by survival. Therefore, since the international system itself is anarchic, states seek alliances. For example, the bipolar structure and actions of states during the Cold War.

2- The first person that comes to mind in the approaches after the Cold War is Francis Fukuyama and his approaches. According to Fukuyama, this is the thesis of the end of history,

because the collapse of the Soviet Union and the liberal order are the peak that humanity will reach. As a concrete example, the democratic situation in Africa and East Asia proves this. According to Fukuyama, the decrease in conflicts and the spread of political economy together with capitalism and the Western form of government were ideal. However, after the 9/11 period, the situation has changed in a way. Despite the rising militancy outside the West, Fukuyama, who exhibits a neo-Kantian approach, believes that the desired order will be fully established after the spread of liberal democracy. The idea that non-liberal states will end conflicts as a result of imitation is a subject open to criticism. As neo-realists mention, ignoring security and power relations and imposing a moral regulation evokes reductionism. Another point that needs to be added, in my opinion, is Huntington's criticism. Increasing ethnic wars, cultural differences and tension are not issues that liberal democracy can eliminate, as Fukuyama mentions.

3- When we examine the foundations of critical theory, we see that knowledge cannot be objective. Knowledge interacts with our social environment and it is obvious that a norm, or culture will affect attempts to obtain knowledge and that complete abstraction is not possible. Therefore, political knowledge cannot remain neutral at this point. The criticism of positivism is also quite appropriate. When we examine mainstream theories, we see a reductionism. For example, in realism, the center of ontology is power. In this respect, the comments made are completely reductionist, and the perspectives on idealism are considered utopian. However, realism is inadequate in explaining the events that occur in international relations holistically. This state-centered perspective in the critique of realism evokes the explanation of every event from the same context. Therefore, since knowledge is included in this scope, it offers a narrow perspective that is biased and evokes the legitimization of power. The politics of knowledge should also evoke other issues. Socially constructed knowledge is important in

terms of what it is used for. It should be liberating. After all, it has the potential to serve the ruling classes because it is ideological.

4- It is clear that the concept of anarchy differs between realists and constructivists. Smit, who also exhibits a perspective close to Wendt, talks about anarchy being socially constructed.

Smit, who also examines the forms of government in ancient Greece, states that every government has a structure that develops with norms. In addition, anarchy is not fixed.

Interactions in social structures can vary through norms. Anarchy can also differ at this point.

The attitudes and perceptions of states are important in terms of the interpretation of anarchy.

Since the perception of a peaceful environment is different, the effect of anarchy will also be

different. For example, institutions can be given as an example, with Smit's words 'when institutions emerge to administer procedural norms, they also promote procedural justice.'

(Smit, 2005). Since institutions can reduce the threat in a way, the structure will be in interaction.

Section 2: Analytical Essays- Prompt1

1- Both theories have approaches to global capitalism. Both Marxism and Critical Theory have made their approaches on a political basis. Although both theories have similar points, they are different. Capitalism is a system that is intertwined with the means of production and the social relations therein. Marxism exhibits the following attitude towards global capitalism;

Social relations in capitalism evoke an asymmetry of social forces distributed according to class positions. (Rupert, 2007). Marxism believes that global capitalism creates inequality.

According to them, the asymmetric difference in these production relations gradually increases inequality. At this point, Marxism, which touches upon the issue of class, has drawn

attention to the inequality between the bourgeoisie and the proletariat. According to Marxism, this inequality is that the proletariat is exploited by the bourgeoisie and that global capitalism is expanding and creating an even more unequal environment. This gap, especially in advanced capitalist regions, increases the asymmetry between the bourgeoisie and the proletariat. In this regard, Marxism has pointed out that a revolution starting from the proletariat, that is, the working class, will reduce this inequality and the potential for a freer order. The main reason why Marxism, which is based on materialism, presents this as a solution is, in fact, the situation of explanation with historical materialism. The concepts that are in relationship with the base-superstructure are determinative. Because it is the precursor in the production of the material base and historical development. It is the state in which the new system reaches a different dimension in dialectical terms (unlike Hegel) with the replacement of feudalism in the previous order by capitalism. In addition, I believe that the theory of dependency is also a useful point in explaining global capitalism. In the relations between the core and peripheral countries, the fact that the peripheral countries remain dependent on the core countries and that the peripheral countries are exploited in this case can be shown as an extension of imperialism. In today's world, the expansionist actions of multinational companies indicate that the peripheral countries are both dependent on them and are exploited. In addition, there is a criticism of the social relations formed by global capitalism. There is also a critique of the social relations shaped by global capitalism. This is as follows: It involves not only mystification or illusion but also the materialization of relations of production. This is one of the characteristics of the economic structure of contemporary society. The phenomenon of fetishism evokes not only social consciousness but also social existence itself. (Musto, 2010). Instead of production being a form of relationship between people, it has been objectified and reduced to goods. The situation that evokes this alienation is the situation where the individual becomes a part of the production system in the

current system of global capitalism. The individual eventually becomes alienated from life itself. Marxists also have their differences, especially the difference between Marx and Engels and the Austrian Marxists on the subject of national loyalty. Marx and Engels stated that issues such as national loyalty would not be a problem with cosmopolitanism and racial differences. However, it is also obvious that cultural issues are ignored. Instead of production being a form of relationship between people, it has been objectified and reduced to goods. The situation that evokes this alienation is the situation where the individual becomes a part of the production system in the current system with global capitalism. The individual eventually becomes alienated from life itself. Marxists also have their differences, especially the difference between Marx and Engels and the Austrian Marxists on the subject of nationalism. Marx and Engels stated that issues such as nationalism would not be a problem with cosmopolitanism and racial differences. However, it is also obvious that cultural issues are ignored. However, Austrian Marxists such as Karl Renner and Otto Bauer have noted that neither Marx nor Engel paid attention to cultural differences, national loyalties, societies that demanded cultural autonomy after a possible socialist order, and the impact of these situations on human history. (Linklater, 2005). I think that this is a situation that Critical Theorists also take into consideration, but they interpret it differently. On the other hand, Critical Theory has also benefited from Marxism to a certain extent and has its criticisms. Critical theory makes an addition by benefiting from Marxism in criticizing global capitalism. The main focus of the theory is to withdraw to the interdisciplinary field instead of including only material reality. At this point, criticism is more effective in interpreting capitalism with cultural and ideological concepts. Because, unlike Marxist theory, Critical Theory has developed the perspective and focus instead of reductionism or narrowing the subject. The effects of capitalism are not only social but also a matter that concerns and affects the subject. An individual-based criticism against capitalism can be found in the work Culture Industry. As

Adorno mentioned; 'Each product affects an individual air; individuality itself serves to reinforce ideology, insofar as the illusion is conjured up that the completely reified and mediated is a sanctuary from immediacy and life' (Adorno, & Rabinbach, 1975).

Consumption is a situation related to commodity fetishism, and instead of the real needs of individuals, it evokes the system encouraging individuals to consume continuously and be in a cyclical time. Immanent critique is an important method in interpreting global capitalism.

Again, we see this clearly in cultural criticism. For example, in the criticism of Adorno and Horkheimer, there is an illusion that capitalism emerged with a promise of freedom under current conditions, but it produces a result that does not match this. Indeed, a state of commodification is not compatible with freedom, on the contrary, the individual becomes part of the current system by transforming himself into an object of consumption. On the other hand, the adaptation of a Weberian approach to critical theory also adds dimension to critical theory. The instrumentalization of reason is a situation where people are constantly calculating and seeking efficiency, but purposeful values are ignored. Capitalism has also brought people to a state where it encourages them to think instrumentally. Therefore, this monotonous state of action shows that people are disconnected from their search for life and become part of the current system. The intensification of global capitalism is also developing simultaneously with this situation. In addition to these, there are some alternative-based approaches. For example, I think it is worthwhile to utilize Cox's form of integration. Cox, who adapts Gramsci's concept of hegemony to international relations, expresses the ideal of an oppositional unity against the inequality of the current system as follows; Cox states that globalization from above must be met with an alternative globalization from below. In addition, the working classes must mobilize and form a global unity through alliances. This also evokes new social movements. (Griffiths et al., 2009). Because capitalism is a system that creates contradictions within itself. Such as increasing unemployment and crises.

Therefore, such solidarity actions can weaken the power of hegemony. In addition, another approach in terms of offering an alternative is as follows: A refined cosmopolitan ethos recognizes the diversity of social and moral ties. Additionally, it enhances the level of political communities. (Devetak, 2005). Critical theory, which offers an alternative, does not exhibit a revolutionary approach, but rather an approach dominated by communication, ethical discourse, and moral values, separate from Marxism. At this point, there is meaning and recognition in issues where culture, norms, etc. are different. The state of unity in common ground with differences within the system is dominant. Again, instead of suggesting what is in the system, it evokes the change of the system. Because, unlike other theories such as realism or liberalism, it does not evoke the legitimization of the current system or does not serve the system completely, on the contrary, questioning the system is one of the fundamental features of Critical Theory. At this point, it may bear similarities with Marxism. However, there are quite a deep differences in terms of method. In summary, the approaches of both theories are mostly acceptable. However, critical theory is more comprehensive and has a broader perspective than Marxism. Because, as in Marxism, it does not only benefit from materialism but also brings together elements of idealism to make criticism. The fact that it makes its criticisms in an interdisciplinary manner also evokes the multifaceted nature of critical theory and its comprehensive approach. The inclusion of the disciplines of psychology and anthropology is a necessary theory both in analyzing the current situation of the subject and in creating an alternative to the order and in terms of the subject being aware of himself. In addition, global capitalism is gaining a different dimension as time goes by. As time goes by, attitudes towards the meaning and value of concepts also change, while the class interpretation was between the concepts of proletariat and bourgeoisie, a separate class emerged from them. With the spread of neoliberalism and the deepening of global capitalism, an insecure environment was created and we started talking about a working class like the

precariat. Although this class has similar characteristics to the proletariat, it adds dimension to understanding the difficulties of the current period.(Elman, 2007). Considering this environment that evokes insecurity and the anarchic order in realism, Russia is under threat. Because NATO moving to Russia's border is a threat to them. Russia aimed to prevent any threat that may come from its immediate region by supporting the separatists in the Donbas region using a conventional method. With this strategy, it aimed to break any resistance that may occur in the region. The main reason why Russia does this, as I mentioned earlier, is the NATO threat. Russia is skeptical of NATO's expansion because it is a formation that can affect its power. Therefore, while carrying out this action, Russia can be shown as actively holding its power in that region and displaying an aggressive attitude toward regional hegemony. Another important issue in regional terms is that the main reason for Ukraine undermining its close relations with the US and the EU is again based on threat perception. Therefore, Russia aims to maximize its power geographically within the scope of a buffer zone in the regions it occupies. On the other hand, I believe that retaliation with economic sanctions also coincides with the theory. Putin blocking the energy routes to Europe in 2022 and ending the gas supply to Austria this week is a retaliation by Russia, securing its place in the international system and is an indication that it is determined in terms of its hegemony in the region. On the other hand, the support that Ukraine receives from the EU and the US also increases tensions for Russia. Although their general approach may seem like an assumption, Russia's concrete actions after the aid provided to Ukraine are more clearly stated in line with this theory. In addition, I think it would be useful to state that other states in the region are also entering into a defense strategy. For example, the tensions experienced during Finland and Sweden's NATO candidacy and Putin's statements after joining NATO. After joining, Putin stated that he could take action after a possible military deployment. Although it may seem like a perspective against security measures, the steady increase in tensions in the region

can be associated with Russia's desire not to lose its power and its maximization of power. In short, Russia, which is in search of regional power, has entered into a search for maximization to eliminate threats from its surroundings because it cannot be sure of the actions of its rivals. In this context, organizations and states were involved in the crisis Russia experienced with Ukraine. I believe that both of these structures deepen the theory.

Section 3: Simulation Exercise

The subject I chose as a territorial dispute is the Russia-Ukraine crisis. This crisis began with Russia's actions, namely the 2014 occupation of Crimea, but its widespread expansion into that region occurred in 2022 and beyond. If we need to interpret this crisis from Russia's perspective, it is to ensure its regional security and prevent possible threats. Again, other reasons why Russia defends its rights in the regions it occupies are that they are culturally important. The theory I think should be used in this case is offensive realism. In his work *The Tragedy of Great Power Politics*, Mearsheimer states that international relations face an uncertain environment in which the power of one state can harm another. It adds dimension to understanding the difficulties of the current period. (Elman, 2007). Considering this environment that evokes insecurity and the anarchic order in realism, Russia is under threat. Because NATO moving to Russia's border is a threat to them. Russia aimed to prevent any threat that may come from its immediate region by supporting the separatists in the Donbas region using a conventional method. With this strategy, it aimed to break any resistance that may occur in the region. The main reason why Russia does this, as I mentioned earlier, is the NATO threat. Russia is skeptical of NATO's expansion because it is a formation that can affect its power. Therefore, while carrying out this action, Russia can be shown as actively holding its power in that region and displaying an aggressive attitude toward regional hegemony. Another important issue in regional terms is that the main reason for Ukraine

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Section 4: Synthesis and Reflection

- When examining the approaches of Smit and Waltz on anarchy, the most important point that separates them is a materialist and critical approach. Waltz talks about the state of anarchy being fixed and an unstoppable reality. With this approach, he defines his objective attitude with a materialist perspective. Smit, on the other hand, exhibits an approach similar to

Wendt and talks about anarchy being a socially constructed phenomenon. Waltz's interpretation of anarchy is as follows: While this fundamental difference represents one's expression of certainty and provides an attempt to legitimize it, according to Smit, anarchy is an element that varies and operates in different dimensions and in different ways over time.

Smit has several criticisms against Waltz. This criticism reveals a somewhat inadequate approach to neorealism. Neorealists, who accept international relations in a uniform strategic way, categorically reject the existence of a union or community of states. They refer to the international system rather than the international society. (Smit, 2005). In general, the fundamental deficiency in realism and its successors is the systemic interpretation of the reality of society. This state-centered perspective is a mechanistic thought that ignores the situations related to humans and legitimizes the increasing tension in the current system. This way of thinking, on the other hand, exhibits a reductionist attitude in making analyses of norms, cultures, and society, and interprets international relations with a one-dimensional perspective. On the other hand, Waltz has the following approach in the case of anarchy:

Waltz argues that in anarchy, states form alliances for self-preservation reasons. The actions of states are related to what they perceive. The power of others becomes only one element in the calculations. (Griffiths, 2007). States do not form alliances only because of anarchy. If this were completely the case, there would be many security crises. Similarly, defensive realism has features in terms of maintaining this anarchy. I believe that this situation will create a dilemma in terms of security. A state trying to ensure its security may become a threat to the states in its immediate vicinity by increasing its material capacity. Since a state trying to become stronger militarily is threatened by another state, the other state may perceive this as a threat. It is also obvious that this situation will lead to a security dilemma, that is, a dead end.

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